

EE 451: Communications Systems

Homework 1 - Complex Numbers, Phasors, and Signal Operations

Topics: Complex numbers, Euler's formula, phasors, signal energy and power **Textbook Reference:** Haykin & Moher, Chapter 2.1

Total Points: 100

Instructions

- Show all work for full credit
 - Include units in all final answers
 - Box or clearly indicate your final answers
 - You may use Python/MATLAB for verification, but show analytical work
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Problem 1: Complex Number Arithmetic (8 points)

Given two complex numbers: - $z_1 = 3 + 4j$ - $z_2 = 2 - 5j$

Calculate the following:

- (a) $z_1 + z_2$ (2 points)
 - (b) $z_1 \cdot z_2$ (2 points)
 - (c) $\frac{z_1}{z_2}$ (express in both rectangular and polar form) (4 points)
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Problem 2: Polar and Rectangular Conversion (10 points)

Convert the following complex numbers between rectangular and polar forms:

- (a) Convert $z = -6 + 8j$ to polar form (magnitude and phase in degrees) (3 points)
 - (b) Convert $z = 15\angle -135^\circ$ to rectangular form (3 points)
 - (c) A signal has magnitude 10 V and phase -60° . Express this in rectangular form and verify that $|z|^2$ equals the sum of the squares of the real and imaginary parts. (4 points)
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Problem 3: Euler's Formula Application (10 points)

Using Euler's formula $e^{j\theta} = \cos(\theta) + j\sin(\theta)$:

- (a) Express $\cos(\omega t)$ as the real part of a complex exponential. (3 points)
- (b) Express $\sin(\omega t + \phi)$ as the imaginary part of a complex exponential. (3 points)

(c) Prove the trigonometric identity:

$$\cos(A) \cos(B) = \frac{1}{2} [\cos(A + B) + \cos(A - B)]$$

using Euler's formula. (4 points)

Problem 4: Phasor Addition (12 points)

Two sinusoidal voltages are added together: - $v_1(t) = 10 \cos(2\pi \cdot 1000 \cdot t + 30^\circ)$ V - $v_2(t) = 15 \cos(2\pi \cdot 1000 \cdot t - 45^\circ)$ V

- (a) Convert each voltage to phasor form. (3 points)
 - (b) Add the phasors to find the resultant phasor V_{total} . (5 points)
 - (c) Convert the resultant phasor back to a time-domain sinusoid $v_{\text{total}}(t)$. (4 points)
 - (d) Verify your answer using Python or MATLAB (optional, 2 points extra credit).
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Problem 5: I/Q Representation (12 points)

A communication signal is represented as:

$$s(t) = I(t) \cos(2\pi f_c t) - Q(t) \sin(2\pi f_c t)$$

where $I(t) = 5$ V and $Q(t) = 12$ V are constant values, and $f_c = 900$ MHz.

- (a) Express $s(t)$ as a single sinusoid in the form $A \cos(2\pi f_c t + \phi)$. Find A and ϕ . (5 points)
 - (b) What is the complex envelope of this signal? (3 points)
 - (c) Sketch the position of this signal in the I/Q plane (complex plane). (4 points)
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Problem 6: Signal Energy (10 points)

Consider the rectangular pulse signal:

$$x(t) = \begin{cases} 5 \text{ V}, & 0 \leq t \leq 2 \text{ seconds} \\ 0, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

- (a) Calculate the energy of this signal. (4 points)
 - (b) Is this an energy signal or a power signal? Justify your answer. (3 points)
 - (c) What would be the energy if the amplitude doubled to 10 V? (3 points)
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Problem 7: Power Signal Analysis (12 points)

A periodic signal is given by:

$$x(t) = 10 \cos(2\pi \cdot 60 \cdot t) + 5 \sin(2\pi \cdot 120 \cdot t) \text{ V}$$

- (a) Calculate the average power of each frequency component separately. (4 points)
 - (b) Calculate the total average power of the signal. (3 points)
 - (c) Is this an energy signal or a power signal? Explain. (3 points)
 - (d) What is the period of the composite signal? (2 points)
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Problem 8: Convolution Fundamentals (8 points)

The unit step function is defined as:

$$u(t) = \begin{cases} 1, & t \geq 0 \\ 0, & t < 0 \end{cases}$$

- (a) Sketch the signal $x(t) = u(t) - u(t - 3)$. (2 points)
 - (b) What is the relationship between the unit step $u(t)$ and the unit impulse $\delta(t)$? (3 points)
 - (c) Let $x(t) = u(t) - u(t - 1)$ and $g(t) = t[u(t) - u(t - 1)]$. Compute the convolution $y(t) = x(t) * g(t)$. Sketch $y(t)$ and label its peak value and support (the interval where $y(t) \neq 0$). (3 points)
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Problem 9: Real-World Application - WiFi Signal (10 points)

A WiFi signal at 2.4 GHz has I and Q components: - $I(t) = 3 \cos(2\pi \cdot 100 \cdot t)$ V - $Q(t) = 4 \cos(2\pi \cdot 100 \cdot t)$ V

where the 100 Hz represents a slow modulating signal (in reality, WiFi modulation is much faster, but we're simplifying).

- (a) Express the complete RF signal $s(t) = I(t) \cos(2\pi f_c t) - Q(t) \sin(2\pi f_c t)$ where $f_c = 2.4$ GHz. (4 points)
 - (b) What is the instantaneous magnitude of the complex envelope at $t = 0$? (3 points)
 - (c) Explain why modern software-defined radios (like the RTL-SDR) output I and Q samples rather than the full RF signal $s(t)$. (3 points)
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Problem 10: Conceptual Understanding (8 points)

Answer the following short-answer questions (2-3 sentences each):

- (a) Why is phasor representation useful in analyzing communication systems? (2 points)
 - (b) What is the physical meaning of the phase angle in a complex number representing a sinusoid? (2 points)
 - (c) Explain the difference between the complex envelope and the actual RF carrier signal in a communication system. (4 points)
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Bonus Problem (5 points extra credit)

Prove that for any complex number $z = a + jb$:

$$z \cdot z^* = |z|^2$$

where z^* is the complex conjugate of z , and $|z|$ is the magnitude of z .

Then explain why this property is useful for calculating signal power in communication systems.

Submission Instructions: - Submit a single PDF via Brightspace - Scanned handwritten work is acceptable if legible - Include any code used for verification

Academic Integrity: - You may discuss concepts with classmates, but all submitted work must be your own - Show your work - answers without supporting calculations will receive minimal credit